

Dubai- All Inclusive Travel Guide

Bon Voyage by Marina

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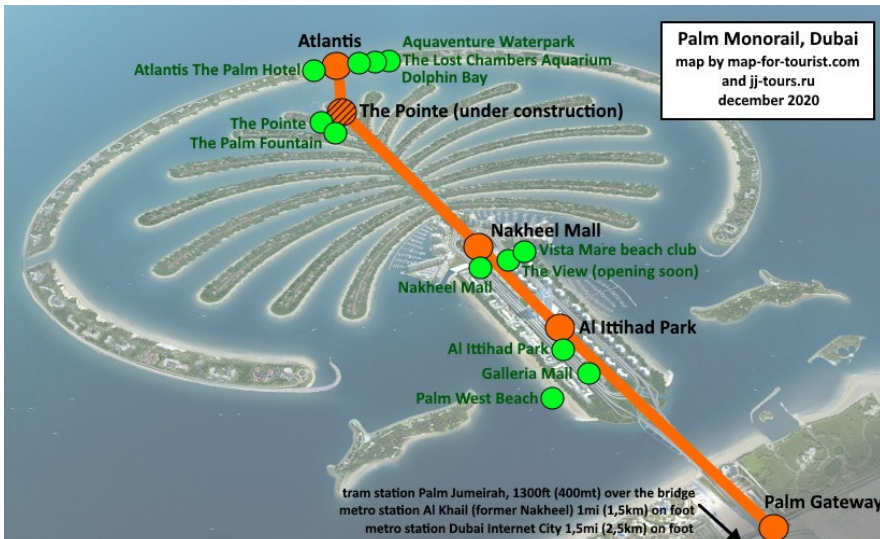
What to buy as souvenirs and from where?

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Thank You!

Detailed Itinerary

Mar 26, Wednesday	Your flight lands at 5:30 pm, transfer to the hotel- Novotel World Trade Centre Dubai, (book a cab on arrival- check getting around section below). relax and head out for the evening. - You can all enjoy the Dubai Fountain Show at the foot of Burj Khalifa, with music and choreographed water jets. - It will take you 35 mins to reach by metro - The show takes place every 30 mins from 6pm onwards till 11 pm and is free. - Have dinner around (at Dubai Mall- check eating out guide below) and head back to your hotel for the night
Mar 27, Thursday	- Spend your morning at Mall of Emirates and have an early lunch here - Make sure to be back at the hotel by 1pm - You will be picked up from your hotel at 2pm for the desert safari - The safari includes dune bashing, BBQ dinner, camel rides, sandboarding, sunset views, and all desert camp activities. - You will be dropped back to the hotel once the experience is complete.
Mar 28, Friday	- Spend the day exploring the popular malls of Dubai and other iconic shopping areas like Meena Bazaar. (more shopping details are in the souvenir buying guide) - Mall Options Dubai Mall Mall of Emirates Dubai Outlet Mall - In the evening, you can head to Jumeirah beach (1hr from the hotel by public transport), walk along the Jumeirah Beach Walking Board and spend time at the beach. You can have dinner at one of the places off Sheikh Zayed Road mentioned in your eating guide below, or around your hotel.
Mar 29, Saturday	- Spend the morning at Dubai Aquarium & Underwater Zoo (35 mins from the hotel by public transport) - Located in Dubai Mall, it boasts a massive 10-million-liter water tank, one of the largest indoor aquariums in the world and is home to over 33,000 aquatic animals. Have lunch at Dubai Mall Evening at Burj Khalifa (7 min walk from the mall) - Ascend to the observation decks for panoramic views of the city from the tallest building in the world- the Burj Khalifa Book tickets in advance- Standard Tickets: Level 124 & 125 or VIP

	level 148 Spend the night at Novotel World Trade Centre Dubai
Mar 30, Sunday	- Visit the Dubai Miracle garden- (1.5 hrs by public transport from the hotel). It is the world's largest flower garden - Average time that visitors spend is about 3 hours. - Prices are 95 AED per adult, 80 AED for upto 11 year olds. - If you like, you can look to visit the Dubai Butterfly garden, which is next to the Miracle Garden and has more than 15,000 butterflies. - Both gardens offer tram services so walking time can be reduced. Tickets for Miracle Garden Tickets for Butterfly Garden - These tickets can also be booked on the same day or even onsite. Spend the evening at the Palm Jumeirah (20 min taxi ride from Miracle garden) , an artificial archipelago with luxurious hotels and resorts Take a monorail ride for an elevated view of the island from Palm Gateway station - You can book these tickets on the same day. - We recommend buying the Day Pass With Unlimited Rides For AED 35 (see the monorail map below) - The final stop for the monorail is at Atlantis the Palm hotel, a must visit place when in Dubai. We recommend starting your trip to the Palm, there. (People typically spend 60-90 mins here) - The Nakheel mall station gives access to The Palm Tower, The View at the Palm, St. Regis Dubai, and Club Vista Mare. The View is another must visit. - The Al Ittihad station connects directly to the Golden Mile Galleria, where visitors can shop to their hearts' content. It also connects to Palm West Beach, an ideal place to swim, eat, and relax by the sea. 

Mar 31, Monday	• Relax in the morning at the hotel, after check out, have lunch and travel to the airport. Fly back to India with memories of a lifetime!

Important Places Around Your Hotel

Novotel World Trade Centre

Convenience stores

- [allday minimart Novotel](#) (2 min walking distance from the hotel)
- [allday minimart IBIS Hotel](#) (8 min walking distance from the hotel)

Hospital

- [Ward 1 - Special Care &nit](#) (10 min taxi drive from the hotel)
- [Hastane](#) (14 min taxi drive from the hotel)

Pharmacy

- [Life Pharmacy](#) (8 min walking distance from the hotel)
- [LIFE Pharmacy 141](#) (12 min walking distance from the hotel)

Important Numbers in Dubai

Here are few numbers you may need while in Dubai

- 999- Police
- 997- Fire
- 998- Ambulance
- 995- Find and rescue
- [Consulate General of India](#): +971 4 397 1333

Recommended things to buy/carry

- Travel Insurance-. Recommendation- TATA AIG
- The weather in Dubai during December is ranging from 21 to 33 degrees. Carry summer caps, sunscreen and pack light cotton clothes during the day. Do also ensure that you carry water with you whenever you are stepping out but please do not drink water in public as it is the Ramadan.
- During Ramadan, eat and drink in restaurants/cafes and designated areas only, out of respect.
- Travel adaptors- Type C, D and G plug adaptor for UAE
- Doctors prescriptions/travel prescriptions for medicines (except over the counter meds)
- Walking shoes!
- Portable chargers (as you will be on the move for most of the time)
- Forex (cash and cards)- our recommendation is the BookMyForex card. Many of our clients have also used the Niyo travel card and have had a good experience.

Common Phrases in Dubai

Arabic Word	Meaning in English
Marhaba	Hello
Kaif Halak?	How are you?
Shukran	Thank you
Na'am	Yes
la	No
Maasalaamah	Goodbye

Recommended Apps

- Google Translate
- Google Maps

Regarding Foreign Currency

- AED also *known as the United Arab Emirates dirham* or simply as the Emirati dirham, is the currency of the United Arab Emirates.
- 1 Dirham is ~23 INR
- While most establishments like restaurants and shops accept cards, you will need cash for small shops and in the souk, as well as street food vendors.
- Exchange money before going and carry forex cash and cards. If you need some additional cash while there, the most cost effective way is to use an ATM. Do check with your banks regarding the charges.
- Ensure that the cards you are carrying are activated for international spends.

Mobile Connectivity while in Dubai

- Etisalat and Du are both widely used networks.
- Prepaid SIM cards in the UAE are sometimes available for free, but mostly they are available with the package for AED 50-100 (depending on the plan you select). They can be picked at the airport.
- The packages of these two companies are also slightly different, but DU's packages are slightly cheaper than Etisalat's.
- Etisalat's 4G coverage is very good and is available in every city and region.
- DU's 5G coverage is better than Etisalat's, but its 5G speed is slightly slower than Etisalat's.
- Most people in Dubai use the Du sim cards.

Getting Around in Dubai

Public Transport

- Please bear in mind that it is not possible to pay in cash for any means of public transport in Dubai.
- The NOL card (Nol Card) is a rechargeable card that allows all public transport in the city to be used in an easy way
- It can be purchased at any metro station.
- There are different types of Nol cards. The Silver card is recommended for tourists. It costs 25 AED which includes a 19 AED credit.
- Download the RTA Dubai app, for information on schedules and prices and also to recharge the Nol card.
- The Nol card can also be recharged at any of the designated recharge machines available at metro and bus stations.

Other pointers to consider:

- Each passenger needs 1 Nol card
- The minimum card balance is 7.5 AED
- The maximum balance value is 1,000 AED for Anonymous nol cards and 5,000 AED for Personal and registered cards
- In order to activate the pending top up, please use your card in any online parking meter, metro gates, nol pay application or Solar Top-up Machines after 45 minutes to 4 hours to update your card balance.
- It is important to remember to swipe the card at the end of your journey, otherwise, you will be charged the maximum fare instead of paying the correct fare.
- The lowest fare is for short journeys of up to 1.8 miles, which allows you 1 transfer of up to 90 minutes. For this option, the price is 3 AED (US\$ 0.80) for silver cards
- You can also use your nol card to pay at certain stores- please refer to this link- <https://www.rta.ae/wps/portal/rta/ae/public-transport/nol/nol-merchants>

Cabs

- You can hail down taxis belonging to the Dubai Taxi Corporation. – these are red topped cars.
- The meter starts at Dhs5 from 6am-10pm, and Dhs5.5 from 10pm-6am and Dhs2.19 per km
- You can also pre book these taxis using the DTC mobile app

Other ride hailing apps

- Careem- which offers the Hala taxi, which are generally affordable rides- Dhs8 starting fee, Dhs12 minimum fare, and Dhs1.91 per km.
- Uber- generally more expensive but since it offers a flat rate, it could work out more affordable during peak hours and for longer distances.

Restaurant options in Dubai

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Comments	Timings and Price per person
Habib Beirut	Lebanese	Mixed grill, hummus	World Trade Centre 12 min walk from the hotel	AED 50-100 per person 12pm-11pm
Royal Palette Greek Restaurant	Greek		10 min by cab from the hotel	6pm- 3am Price not specified
Al fresco Italian Restaurant	Italian	Pizzas, pastas, rissoto	Located in Millenium Plaza Downtown Hotel	AED 100- 150 per person 12pm-11pm
Bombay Chowpatty	Indian street food	Pav Bhaji, Chole Bature, Dosa	Multiple locations Sheikh Zayed road Mall of Emirates, Dubai Mall	Open 8 am- 1130 pm AED 1-50 per person
Carluccio	Italian	Pastas and pizzas, handmade foccacia	Dubai Mall	Popular Italian chain AED 50-150 per person Open 9am- 12 am

L'eto Dubai	Bakery and cake shop	Pistachio cake, macarons, milk cake	Dubai Mall	Open 9am-12am
TimeOut Market Dubai	Food hall	Baos, pizzas, Phos	Near dubai Mall and fountain	Open 12pm-12am
Parkers	French	Matilda Cake, fries, burgers	Dubai Mall	AED 50-150 per item open 9am-11:30ppm
Chocomelt	Chocolate Cafe	Baby Dynamite, Popcorn mountain banana pudding, biscoff crepe	Dubai Mall	AED 50-100 per item open 10:00 am-12am
Public	Multicuisine (mostly Italian)	Has veg options, Curly corn, pizzas, tiramisu, crazy truffle pasta, parmesan fries,	Dubai Mall	Open 9am-1am
Bosporous Turkish	Turkish	Has veg options, mezze platters,	Dubai Mall	Open 8am-12:30am

Cuisine		cheese rolls, turkish tea		
Hafiz Mustafa 1864	Turkish sweets	Baklava, turkish delights, turkish coffee	Dubai Mall	AED 50-150 per item Open 8am-12:00am
Bikanerwala	Indian	Breakfast, Quick lunch and dinner Sweet options	Sheikh Zayed Road	Reasonably priced AED 1-50 per person Open 8am-12 am.
SpiceKlub	Indian	Vegetarian	Al Mankhool, Option for if you visit the souks	Modern presentation Open 12-3:30pm 6:30-11:30 pm AED 50-100 per person
Leila	Lebanese	Serves veg and vegan dishes also. Mezze plates, salads, pizzas	Downtown Dubai	10am- 12:45 am
Zaroob	Arabic	Serves veg and vegan dishes also- Mezze plates, salads, pizzas	Jumeriah Tower Building, Sheik Zayed Road, Live cooking stations on 2 floors recreating Arabic street fare with a twist, in a market	AED 50-100 per person

			setting. Has outdoor seating	
Taquado Mexican Kitchen	Mexican	Veg options, fajitas, burriots and tacos and burgers	Mall of Emirates	AED 1-50 per person Open 10am-10 pm
Aroos Damascus	Syrian	Serves veg and vegan also-. Mezze plates, salads, mains like moussaka	Sheik Zayed Road	AED 50-100 per person Open 11am- 4 pm
Flaky Pastry Dubai	Bakery and Cake shop	Croissants, cinnamon rolls, coffee, crookie, vanilla flan	City Walk II	AED 50-100 per item open 7:30am-10pm
Fi'lia Dubai	Italian	Has veg dishes. Truffle izza, pavlova, cacio e pepe pasta, tiramisu	SLS Dubai Hotels and Residences, Dubai Business Bay. Beautiful terrace setting	Open 12:30-3:30 pm 6:30pm-12am Located on the 70th floor Reservations required sevenrooms.com
Bombay Bungalow	Mumbai Street Food	Samosas, pav bhaji	The Beach Mall, JBR Walk	AED 50-150 per person Open 10 am- 12 pm
Berenjack Dubai	Persian	Saffron rice, iranian bread, = eggplant, hummus, baklava	Jumeirah	Open 12-5pm 6-11:30pm

Milk Bakery	Bakery and cake shop	Breakfast/brunch, Turkish eggs,Avocado toast, Pastries, milk chocolate cookie, coffee	Jumeirah	AED 50-100 per item open 7:30am-12am Sat-sun open from 8am
Bluebarjeel restaurant	Arabic	Shawarmas, kubz, Turkish coffee	Option for if you visit the Souks Seating by the creek	AED 1-100 per dish
Maraheb Restaurant	Yemini	Mandi, Hanith	Off sheik Zayed road	AED 50-100 per dish 11am-11:30pm

Famous Vegetarian Local Dishes

- **Fattoush:** This vibrant salad is a refreshing and healthy option. It's made with toasted or fried pita bread pieces tossed with chopped vegetables, herbs, and a tangy lemon dressing.
- **Balaleet:** This sweet vermicelli dish is traditionally served for breakfast but can be enjoyed at any time of day. It's made with fried vermicelli noodles, cardamom, saffron, rosewater, and topped with fried nuts and raisins.
- **Mutabbal:** This creamy eggplant dip is a popular mezze dish. It's made with roasted eggplant, tahini, lemon juice, olive oil, and garlic.
- **Moussaka:** This layered eggplant dish is a vegetarian take on the classic Greek dish. It's made with layers of fried eggplant, tomatoes, onions, and a creamy bechamel sauce.
- **Falafel:** A famous Middle Eastern street food, falafel is a deep-fried patty or ball made from ground chickpeas, fava beans, or lentils. It's typically served in a pita bread with hummus, tahini, chopped vegetables, and amba sauce.
- **Tabbouleh:** This refreshing salad is a staple of Levantine cuisine. It's made with finely chopped parsley, tomatoes, mint, onions, bulgur wheat, and a lemon dressing.
- **Lentil Soup:** Hearty and flavorful, lentil soup is a popular comfort food in Dubai. It's made with lentils, vegetables, and spices.
- **Vegetable Biryani:** This fragrant rice dish is a vegetarian version of the classic Indian biryani. It's made with basmati rice, vegetables, spices, and nuts.
- **Stuffed Grape Leaves:** Also known as yaprak in Turkish cuisine, stuffed grape leaves are a popular appetizer or side dish. They're made with grape leaves stuffed with rice, vegetables, and herbs.
- **Luqaymat-** These homely sweet pastries are shaped into delicate golden balls that melt in the mouth. They're made from flour, sesame seeds, turmeric, milk, sugar, salt, and a little yeast. The batter is kneaded and then left to rest for a while, before being fried in oil and drizzled with syrup.
- **Knafeh-**made of spun pastry, soaked in sweet syrup, layered with melting cheese, and served with clotted cream, pistachio, or other nuts.
- **Khubz or 'Kuboos'** is a classic soft Arabic bread made with all-purpose or wheat flour. Try the freshly made ones at a bakery or restaurant with fresh hummus and an aubergine dip called 'mutabal' as its perfect accompaniment. You can also use the Khubz to wrap all the juicy, delicious ingredients of shawarma, and it can also be paired with any gravy dishes.

Famous Non- Vegetarian Local Dishes

- **Harees:** The ingredients for harees are crushed wheat, minced meat (sometimes chicken), as well as onions, ground cumin, a generous amount of water, and salt. Emirati harees is considered one of the country's best-known traditional dishes.
- **Majboos-** The dish includes basmati rice served with various types of meat. Emirati majboos are frequently served with chicken, with the distinctive flavours of powerful Arabian spices and assorted vegetables
- **Madrouba-** Madrouba with chicken is the best-known variety, though it's also served with fish, lamb, and crushed grains. It's prepared using rice, garlic, onion, tomatoes, yoghurt and seasoning. Butter is also used in moderation.
- **Biryani-** There are several varieties of biryani, including: Iranian, katchi, Sri Lankan, and Southeast Asian. Made with a mix of basmati rice and spices, meat biryani can be served with chicken or other types of meat.
- **Chicken Saloona-** It's prepared with pieces of chicken, turmeric, olive oil, grated ginger, minced garlic, onion, chilli, spices and white rice.
- **Oozie-** This dish is made with rice and can be stuffed into delicate pastry pockets, or it can also be served with chicken. Sometimes, it's also served with salad and yoghurt, or garnished with a mixture of fried or roasted nuts.
- **Jasheed-** It's made from small sharks, or other fish if these aren't available, and eaten with rice. It's served with white 'aysh (rice) and clarified butter
- **Tahta malih** is a traditional dish of Dubai that's still popular today. Its original flavours have been preserved, just like the fish that is used to make it
- **Chebab-** The *chebab* is a traditional Emirati pancake and a favorite breakfast staple in Dubai. This popular food is thickened with yeast, delicately flavored with cardamom, saffron, and turmeric, and typically served with date syrup, cheese, or eggs.
- **Margoogat** is a succulent Arabic stew, typically made with chicken or lamb and flavored with tomato, garam masala, spices, and vegetables, creating a delicious blend of sweet, spicy, and tangy flavors. It is often served with yogurt or cucumber salad.
- **Khuzi-** It's a tenderly cooked lamb dish with a base of spicy rice and a topping of raisins, vegetables, and roasted nuts, flavored with cardamom, cinnamon, saffron, and nutmeg.
- **Regag** is the most well-known Arabic bread. Cooked on a special pan over high heat, it's a wafer-thin bread that is the perfect base for all kinds of foods, from kebabs to eggs to chocolate spread.

What to buy as souvenirs and from where?

Type of souvenir	Category	Where to buy
Dates	Consumable	Popular brands- Bateel Dates, Al Barakah Dates, Date Crown Supermarkets Date Souk at the Grand Souk
Spices (Especially saffron, cumin, turmeric and cinnamon)		Supermarkets or the Deira Spice Souk
Arabic coffee		Supermarkets
Camel Milk Chocolate		Brand – Al Nassma kiosks at Dubai Mall Bhurj Khalifa The Palm Souk Madinat Jumeirah
Dried fruits and nuts		Supermarkets
Sweets (Baklava, Khabees, Maamoul, and Batheeth)		Alreef Lebanese Bakery , Al Baba Sweets The Hummingbird Bakery, Mall of Emirates .
Oud and Bakhoor (types of incense)	Personal products (perfume/jewellery /garments/accessories)	Traditional perfume shops in malls and the souks like Perfume Souk in Deira
Gold jewellery		Gold Souk in Deira Joyalukkas outlets
Traditional Arab shoes		Grand Souk
Arabic Attar (concentrated perfumes made from essential oils, musk, amber etc)		Popular brands- Swiss Arabian Perfumes, Rasasi Perfume Traditional perfume shops in malls and the souks like Perfume Souk in Deira

		Deira
Kaftans		Grand Souk Malls like Dubai Mall Souk Madinat Jumeirah
Carpets	Keepsakes	Souk Madinat Jumeirah Dubai Mall National Iranian Carpets at Jumeirah Beach National Iranian Carpets at Mall of Emirates
Aladdin lamps		Karama Souq
Kava pots and coffee sets		Dubai Coffee Museum Dubai Mall Mall of Emirates
Incense holders		Souks like the Deira Spice Souk Home Décor Stores in malls
Lanterns (made of copper and tin with filigree work)		Dragon Mart Homes R Us
Electronic gadgets	Electronics	Sharaf DG store, Dubai Mall Bur Dubai area's Al-Fahidi Street
Clothes	Fashion	Dubai Outlet Mall Dubai Outlet Village

Shopping Notes

Electronics: The Bur Dubai Market or commonly known as Meena Bazar is one of the best markets to shop electronics. The street is full of stores that are known to sell everything in electronics such as

Gaming Consoles, Cameras, smartphones, laptops, etc. All the stores here in Bur Dubai are known to offer the best electronics at a rock bottom price. Some of the well-known stores here are Jumbo Electronics and Sharaf DG.

Sharaf DG in particular will be having sales during the Dubai Shopping Festival (during last years festival they offered upto 40% off)

In case you do not want to make a separate trip to Meena Bazar, you can visit Sharaf DG outlets at Mall of Dubai and Mall of Emirates (as part of your current itinerary)

Gold:

Gold souk and gold souk extension- There are over 300 retailers in the Gold Souk so take your time looking around and shopping for the best possible prices and rates. The rates can vary based on the making charges and the wastage of the design. Don't be afraid to haggle, because that is an absolute must here and the shopkeepers expect it!

Joyalukkas, Damas, Damiani, Malabar Gold and Diamonds, Rossella, Taiba, and Kalyan Jewellers are the main jewellers that are recommended

Bringing Gold from Dubai to India

A male traveler can bring 20 grams of gold (up to a maximum value of Rs 50,000) free of customs charge. they can bring gold coins or bars

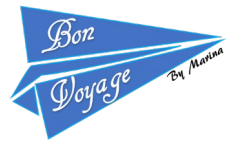
The duty-free gold limit for female travelers from Dubai is 40 grams, with a maximum value of Rs 1 lakh. When returning from Dubai, women can carry gold in the form of coins, bars, or jewelry

Gold ornaments weighing up to 40 grams are allowed for children under the age of 15 to import without incurring customs duties. This includes gifts or presents in the form of gold. The children, however, must produce identity proof of their relationship to the adults accompanying them

Gold coins are subject to a 10% customs fee if the total weight of the imported coins is less than 100 grams per passenger. 10% custom duty is applied to the total value of the gold coins when their combined weight is between 20 and 100 grams. No customs charge is required if the total weight of the imported gold coin is less than 20 grams.

Passengers traveling from Dubai to India with gold must provide appropriate documents, such as gold purchase invoices and purity and quality certificates. The appropriate inscriptions ought to be on any gold bars you carry. There ought to include information such as the bar's weight and serial number. Incorrect information provided by passengers may lead to fines and, in certain cases, seizure

Perfumes: Perfume Souk- Ajmal Store, Swiss Arabian- Both offer the finest Arabic and French-inspired fragrances in all their forms, whether as sticks, stones, oils or powders.



Thank You!

Thank you for trusting us with the opportunity to plan your vacation!

We hope your trip is filled with unforgettable memories and special moments together.

Remember, we're always here to assist you—before, during, and even after your journey. Just a call or message away!

Bon Voyage By Marina - 86000-15316